V-L-61c
OCTOBER 20, 1959
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. V–L–0061b (Army–QMC)
August 5, 1959 and
Fed. Spec V–L–61a
July 1, 1953

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

LACES, FOOTWEAR, SPUN NYLON

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope.—This specification covers one type of spun-nylon laces for use as closures for various types of footwear.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types, classes, and lengths.*—Laces shall be of one type in the following classes and lengths, as specified (see 6.2):

Class 1.—7/32-inch width.
Lengths.—21, 25, 27, 28½, 30, 40, 50, 52, 54, and 84 inches.

Class 2.—1 9/32-inch width.
Lengths.—30, 40, 44, 52, 60, and 64 inches.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

UU–P–268—Paper, Kraft, Wrapping.
UU–T–111 — Tape, Paper, Gummed (Sealing and Securing).
CCC–T–191—Textile Test Methods.
PPP–B–591—Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP–B–601—Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP–B–621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP–B–636—Boxes, Fiber.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL–B–10377 — Box, Wood, Cleated, Veneer, Paper Overlaid.
MIL–L–10547 — Liners, Case, Waterproof.

FSC 8335

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Military Standards:

MIL–STD–105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL–STD–129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Sample.—Samples are furnished solely for guidance and information to the contractor (see 6.3). Variations from this specification may appear in the sample, in which case this specification shall govern.

3.2 Preproduction sample.—Unless otherwise specified, before production is commenced, the contractor shall submit a finished pair of laces to the contracting officer for approval.

3.3 Material.

3.3.1 *Nylon.*—The nylon used in the manufacture of the laces shall be nylon 66 (polyhexamethylene adipamide) fiber. The use of regenerated or reprocessed nylon is prohibited. The contractor shall certify that the nylon used in the laces conforms to the type specified (see 4.3.1.2). When identification of the fiber is required (see 6.2), the contracting officer may authorize test requirements described in 4.4.

3.3.1.1 *Nylon staple.* — The nylon staple shall be of suitable staple length and denier to comply with the requirements of this specification.

3.3.2 *Yarn.* — The nylon staple shall be evenly spun and twisted into a two-ply yarn.

3.3.3 *Tips.*—The tips shall be made from nylon sheet or film having a thickness of 0.015 inch (plus 0.001, minus 0.002 inch), and shall be transparent and colorless or approximately the same color as the lace.

3.4 Color.—The color of the finished laces shall be as specified (see 6.2). Dyed laces shall be dyed with applicable chromiferous (metallized)chrome, acid, direct dyes or combinations thereof. The laces shall be well soaped and washed after dyeing.

3.4.1 *Color matching.* — The color shall match the approved standard shade under natural (north sky) daylight, or artificial daylight having a color temperature of 7500° Kelvin and shall be a good approximation to the standard shade under incandescent lamplight at 2800° Kelvin.

3.4.2 *Colorfastness.*

3.4.2.1 *Rating per standard sample.*—The dyed laces shall show fastness to crocking and light equal to or better than the standard sample when tested as specified in 4.4.

3.4.2.2 *Rating per no standard sample.*—When no standard sample is available, the dyed laces shall show fair fastness to crocking and good fastness to light when tested as specified in 4.4.

3.5 Braid. — The laces shall be tubular braided, two over and two under without a core, and pressed flat in accordance with commercial practice. The finished laces shall conform to the requirements in table I when tested as specified in 4.4.

3.6 Tipping.—Both ends of the braid shall be provided with a firmly attached and secured tip made from the material specified in 3.3.3. Tips shall be $\frac{3}{4} \pm \frac{1}{16}$ inch long.

3.6.1 *Gripping strength.*—The nylon tips shall have a minimum gripping strength of 25 pounds for class 1 laces and 40 pounds for class 2 laces when subjected to the test specified in 4.4.

3.6.2 *Compression strength.* — The tips shall not be cracked, dislodged from their position, or peeled from the lace when tested as specified in 4.4.

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TABLE I.—*Physical requirements*

Class	Width	Ends per carrier	Carriers, minimum	Picks per inch, minimum	Breaking strength, minimum
	Inch				*Pounds*
1	7/32 ± 1/32	1	44	38	100
2	10/32 ± 1/32	2	44	26	175

3.7 Length.—Laces shall be furnished in lengths, including tips, as specified (see 1.2.1 and 6.2). The laces shall be cut so as to insure the specified length when tested as specified in 4.4. Classes 1 and 2 laces under 40 inches may have a length tolerance of plus 5 percent and laces 40 inches and longer may have a length tolerance of plus 3 percent.

3.8 Workmanship.—The finished laces shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. Occurrence of defects shall be limited by the acceptable quality levels established herein.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Contractor inspection responsibility.—Unless otherwise specified herein, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements prior to submission for Government inspection and acceptance. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any other commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be kept complete and made available to the Government as specified in the contract or order.

4.2 Preacceptance inspection.

4.2.1 *Preproduction inspection.*—When required, inspection and testing of the preproduction sample shall be made of the completed laces for all provisions of this specification applicable to end product examination and tests.

4.3 Inspection for acceptance.—Except when otherwise specified by Civil agencies, determination of acceptability of product as to compliance with the requirements of this specification shall be in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.3.1.1 *Testing of components.*—In addition to the quality assurance testing provisions of the subsidiary specifications and drawings, testing shall be performed on components and material listed in table II for the characteristics shown therein. The inspection level (sample size) shall be determined from table III–B of Military Standard MIL–STD–105.

4.3.1.2 *Certification of compliance.*—Material listed below may be accepted on the basis of a contractor's certification of compliance for requirements specified in applicable paragraphs of this specification (see 6.2).

Material	Characterstics	Requirement paragraph
Nylon	Nylon identification	3.3.1
	Type nylon (not regenerated or reprocessed)	3.3.1

4.3.2 *In-process inspection.* — Inspection shall be made at any point or during any phase of the manufacturing process to determine whether operation or assemblies are accomplished as specified. The Government reserves the right to exclude from considera-

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TABLE II

Component and lot expressed in terms of	Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method	Requirement applicable to		Number determinations per sample unit	Results reported as	Sample unit	Inspection level	AQL
				Individual unit	Lot average					
Nylon sheet (10 sheets)	Thickness	3.3.3	Gauge	X	--	3	Average of 3 determinations to the nearest 0.001 inch	6- by 6-in. piece or equivalent	L–1	6.5
	Material identification	3.3.3	Std. comm'l	X	--	1	Pass or fail		L–1	6.5

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tion for acceptance any material for which in-process inspection has indicated nonconformance.

4.3.3 *Inspection of the end item.*

4.3.3.1 *Visual examination of laces.*—The defects found during examination shall be classified in accordance with 4.3.3.1.1, 4.3.3.1.2 and 4.3.3.1.3. The lots shall be inspected in accordance with 4.3.3.1.4. The sample unit for these examinations shall be one completely finished lace.

4.3.3.1.1 *Examination of laces for defects in material and workmanship.*

Examine	Defect
General	Any defect of component or fabrication not specifically classified herein affecting appearance or affecting serviceability.
Material	Any broken thread.
	Frayed.
	Rub or abrasion marks.
	Hole, cut or tear.
	Unevenly braided resulting in open place or break in continuity of braid.
	Pulled thread or uneven tension resulting in uneven width.
	Other than tubular braided without a core.
	Not flat for a distance of more than 2 inches.
	Slub, knot, or abruptly thickened place which may affect utility.
	Color other than specified.
	Visibly off shade, i.e., not within established tolerances.
	Spot, stain, or other discoloration affecting appearance.
	Objectionable odor.
Tipping	Any tip missing, damaged, malformed, or insecurely attached.
	Tipping of braid not neatly accomplished.
	Not fabricated of nylon sheet.
	Color other than transparent and colorless or not approximately the same color as the lace.
	End of tip projects beyond the braid visibly more than 1/32 inch.
	End of braid projects beyond the tip end more than 1/32 inch.

4.3.3.1.2 *Examination of laces for overall width.*—Any overall width (measured in accordance with 4.4.1) that exceeds the specified tolerances of table I shall be classified a defect.

4.3.3.1.3 *Examination for overall length of tip ends.*—Any overall length of tip exceed the specified tolerances indicated in 3.6 shall be classified a defect.

4.3.3.1.4 *Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's).* — The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as follows:

	Inspection levels	AQL's
For examination indicated in 4.3.3.1.1	I	1.0 dhu
For examination indicated in 4.3.3.1.2	L–6	1.0 dhu
For examination indicated in 4.3.3.1.3	L–6	1.0 dhu

4.3.4 *Inspection of preservation, packaging, packing, and marking.*—Examination will be made of preservation, packaging, packing, and marking to determine compliance with section 5 of this specification and contract requirements.

4.4 **Testing of the end item.**—Testing of the completely fabricated laces shall be performed in accordance with table III for the characteristics shown therein. The sample unit shall be twenty completely fabricated laces. The requirements are applicable to the individual unit. The inspection level (sample size) shall be L–1 (determined from table III–B of Military Standard MIL–STD–105) using an AQL of 6.5 defects per hundred units.

4.4.1 *Width.*—The width shall be determined at three points at least 9 inches apart by a steel rule calibrated in thirty-seconds of

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TABLE III

Test characteristics	Requirement reference	Test method	Number determinations per sample unit	Results reported as
Ply of yarns	3.3.2	Visual	1	Number of plies
Weave (braid)	3.5	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Width	table I	(see 4.4.1)	3	To the nearest 1/32 inch
Ends of carrier	table I	Visual	1	Number of ends
Carriers	table I	Visual	1	Number of carriers
Picks per inch	table I	Visual	1	Number of picks
Breaking strength	table I	(see 4.4.3)	10	Average of 10 determinations to the nearest 0.5 pound
Overall length	3.7	(see 4.4.2)	1	To the nearest 1/16 inch
Gripping strength of tips	3.6.1	(see 4.4.6)	10	Average of 10 determinations to nearest 1.0 pound
Compression strength	3.6.2	(see 4.4.4)	1	Pass or fail
Identification of nylon 66 (when applicable)	3.3.1	(see 4.3.1.2 and 4.4.5)	2	To the nearest degree centigrade
Dye identification	3.4	St. comm'l	1	Pass or fail
Colorfastness to: Crocking	3.4.2.1 or 3.4.2.2 (as applicable)	Method 4650, CCC–T–191 [1]	1	"Satisfactory or unsatisfactory" when standard sample is available. "Excellent, good, fair or poor" when no standard sample is available.
Light	3.4.2.1 or 3.4.2.2 (as applicable)	Method 4660, CCC–T–191	1	"Satisfactory or unsatisfactory" when standard sample is available. "Excellent, good, fair or poor" when no standard sample is available.

[1] Apparatus, procedure, and method of reporting shall be in accordance with Method 5651.

an inch and the results averaged. The width shall be measured flat with the test lace under no tension.

4.4.2 *Length.*—The finished lace shall not be stretched or tensioned prior to the length test. The finished lace shall be suspended vertically under a tension of 3 ounces for class 1 and 6 ounces for class 2, and then measured from end to end including the tips.

4.4.3 *Breaking strength.*—The breaking strength of the laces shall be determined as specified in Federal Specification CCC–T–191,

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method 4102, except that the clamps shall be not less than 2 inches in diameter and the distance between the center of the clamps at the start of the test shall be 6 ± 1/16 inches.

4.4.4 *Compression strength.*—The tip shall be placed between flat blocks of steel and subjected to a gradually applied crushing load of 1000 pounds.

4.4.5 *Identification of nylon.*—When identification of nylon 66 is required (see 6.2), the nylon 66 shall have a melting point of 250° ± 6°C (482° ± 10° F) when tested as follows:

4.4.5.1 *Test specimen.*—The specimen shall be 3 to 4 milligrams of nylon prepared by cutting the fiber or yarn into lengths of 1/8 to 1/4 inch or less.

4.4.5.2 *Apparatus.*—Apparatus consisting essentially of an electrically heated stage having a circular depression large enough to insert a 19mm. micro cover glass, a powerstat controlling the rate of heat imput into the stage, and an armored thermometer inserted in the stage. The thermometer shall be a solid stem thermometer graduated from 20° to 300°C. in 1° divisions. A low-powered magnifying glass, micro cover glasses (round 19mm.) and a spatula or pick needle shall be provided.

4.4.5.3 *Procedure.*—The stage shall be preheated to or above the expected melting point of the specimen and then cooled to approximately 50°C. below this temperature before an initial determination is made. If the approximate melting point of the specimen is not known before testing, it is to be determined by a trial run. The specimen shall be placed in a small mound between two cover glasses. The two cover glasses shall be pressed together gently but firmly and placed in the circular depression on the stage. The temperature of the stage shall be raised with some rapidity to within 15°C. of the expected melting point and thereafter at a rate of 3° to 4°C. per minute. At this rate of temperature rise, a slight pressure shall be applied on the upper micro glass cover by pressing with a spatula or pick needle. The specimen is observed with the aid of a magnifying glass and the melting point is taken as the temperature at which flow of the specimen is observed. At the observed melting point, the thermometer shall be read to the nearest degree. In subsequent determinations immediately following the initial determination, the stage in each case shall be cooled to approximately 50°C. below the expected melting point before the specimen is placed for testing.

4.4.5.4 *Report.*—Two specimens shall be tested from each Unit-of-Product. The melting point of the Unit-of-Product shall be the average of the results obtained from the specimens tested and shall be reported to the nearest degree Centigrade.

Note.—An apparatus of the type described in this method is manufactured by the Fisher Scientific Company, and named the Fisher-Johns Melting Point Apparatus.

4.4.6 *Gripping strength of tips.*

4.4.6.1 *Test specimen.*—The specimen shall be a 1/2 length of a shoe lace. (Two determinations may be made from one complete shoe lace.)

4.4.6.2 *Apparatus.*

4.4.6.2.1 *Testing machine.*—A testing machine as described in method 5100, except a slotted metal plate as shown in figure 1, shall be used in connection with the top jaw assembly and the distance between the upper jaw (slotted metal plate) and the lower jaws or clamps shall be 4 ± 1/16 inches. The lower jaw shall be as described in method 5100 or 4102 of Federal Specification CCC–T–191.

4.4.6.2.2 *Metal plate (figure 1).*—A rigid metal plate of the approximate dimensions 5 inches long by 1 1/2 inches wide, containing a 4-inch tapered slot, centered widthwise and running lengthwise from an inside dimension of 1/32 inch in width, increasing to a width

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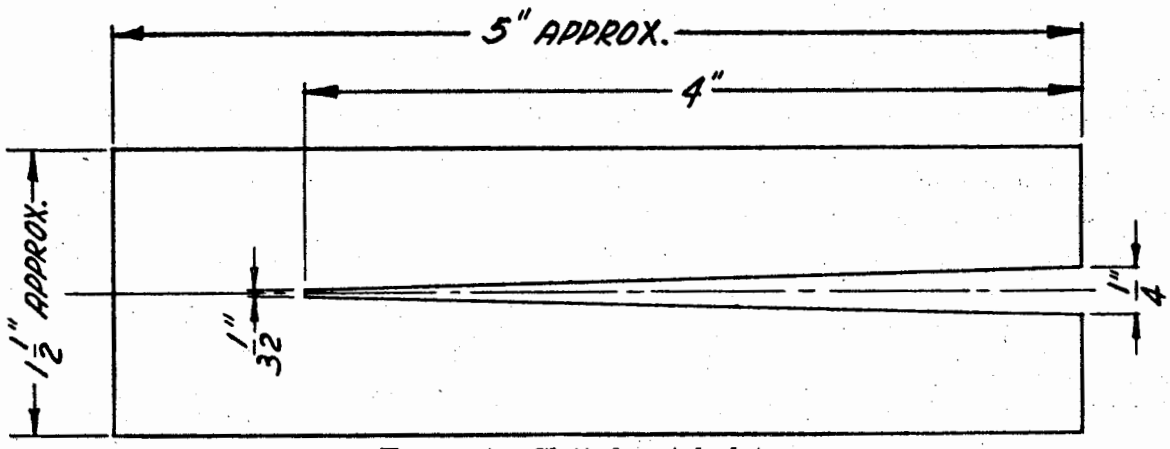


FIGURE 1.—Slotted metal plate.

of ¼ inch at the outside edge. The slot shall be smoothly finished. It is not required that the plate be of a single piece of metal. The slot may be formed by a clamped or bolted assembly of two metal bars or plates properly spaced apart. The plate shall be supported in a horizontal position in or on top jaw of the apparatus.

4.4.6.3 *Procedure.* — The lace shall be passed upward, tip first, through the jaw assembly and through the wide end of the slot until the tip clears the plate and then moved horizontally toward the narrow end of the slot until the end of the tip rests on top of the metal plate. The free end of the specimen (lace) shall be fastened in the lower jaw or clamp. The machine shall be started, with the pawl in contact with the ratchet, and the maximum resistance in displacing the tip shall be recorded. The force shall be applied to the specimen at such a rate that the pulling clamp will travel at a uniform speed of 12 ± 0.5 inches per minute. After the tip has been forced from the lace, the resultant force shall be read from the dial, scale, or chart and the value recorded to the nearest pound. If the lace tip slips through the slot without its being removed from the lace or if for any reason attributed to faulty technique, an individual measurement falls markedly below the average test for the unit of product, such result shall be discarded and another specimen shall be tested. Buckling of the tip material at the base of the tip without the tip being removed from the lace shall not be considered as a failure of the tip and the result shall be discarded and another specimen shall be tested.

4.4.6.4 *Report.*—Ten specimens shall be tested from each unit of product. The gripping strength of the unit of product shall be the average of the results and shall be reported to the nearest 1.0 pound.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(Federal Standard No. 102 shall be referred to for definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging and packing protection for supplies and equipment (for Civil agencies only).

5.1 **Packaging.**—Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A.*—Five gross of laces of one class, length, and color only, shall be put up in a bundle having approximate overall dimensions as specified in table IV. Prior to bundling, the laces shall be grouped full length in one gross lot and securely tied together. Each bundle of laces shall be completely wrapped in 60-pound kraft paper conforming to grade B of Federal Specification UU–P–268. The wrap shall be securely sealed with 2-inch minimum width gummed paper tape conforming to class 2 of Federal Specification UU–T–111.

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5.1.2 *Level C.*—Laces shall be packaged in accordance with good commercial practice.

5.2 **Packing.**—Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.*—Laces, of one class, length, and color only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed within a ~~snug-fitting~~ fiberboard shipping container conforming to class 2, V3c or V3s, style RSC of Federal Specification PPP–B–636. Alternatively, shipping containers conforming to overseas type of Federal Specifications PPP–B–591, PPP–B–601, or Military Specification MIL–B–10377; or class 2, style 2 or 4 of Federal Specification PPP–B–621, except that the requirements for additional battens shall not apply, ~~may be used.~~ Level A packages shall be packed in quantities and arranged within shipping containers having dimensions as specified in Table IV. Each shipping container shall be provided with a type I or II, grade B or C, class 2 sealed case liner conforming to Military Specification MIL–L–10547. Each container shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the Appendix of the applicable container specification.

5.2.2 *Level B.*—Laces of one class, length, and color only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed within a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to type I or II, class 1, style RSC of Federal Specification PPP–B–636. Minimum bursting strength of the fiberboard shall be 275 p.s.i. All flaps of the fiberboard shipping container shall be securely sealed with an adhesive commercially used for the specific product being packed by application throughout the entire area of contact between the flaps, or by a combination of metal stitching the bottom flaps and sealing the top flaps with adhesive. Alternatively, shipping containers conforming to domestic type, style A or B of Federal Specification PPP–B–591, PPP–B–601, or Military

TABLE IV.—*Packing details*

Class	Length	Bundle [1]	Arrangement in container				Shipping container [1]		
		Overall dimensions					Inside dimensions (inches)		
			Quantity	Length	Width	Depth	Length	Width	Depth
	Inches	*Inches*							
1	21	10½ by 7½ by 3½	16	2	2	4	21	15	14¼
1	25	12½ by 7½ by 3½	16	2	2	4	27	15	14¼
1	27	13½ by 7½ by 3½	16	2	2	4	27	15	14¼
1	28½	14½ by 7½ by 3½	16	2	2	4	30	15	14¼
1	30	15 by 7½ by 3½	16	2	2	4	30	15	14¼
1	40	10 by 15 by 3½	16	2	2	4	30	20	14¼
1	50	25 by 7½ by 3½	8	1	2	4	27	15	14¼
1	52	26 by 7½ by 3½	8	1	2	4	27	15	14¼
1	54	27 by 7½ by 3½	8	1	2	4	27	15	14¼
1	84	21 by 15 by 3½	8	2	1	4	30	21	14¼
2	30	15 by 7½ by 7	8	2	2	2	30	15	14¼
2	40	10 by 15 by 7	8	2	2	2	30	20	14¼
2	44	11 by 15 by 7	8	2	2	2	30	22	14¼
2	52	26 by 7½ by 7	4	1	2	2	27	15	14¼
2	60	30 by 7½ by 7	4	1	2	2	30	15	14¼
2	64	16 by 15 by 7	4	2	1	2	30	16	14¼

[1] Bundle and container dimensions are approximations ~~only and must be verified by contractor.~~

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Specification MIL–B–10377; or class 1, style 2 or 4 of Federal Specification PPP–B–621, except that the requirements for additional battens shall not apply, may be used. Level A packages shall be packed in quantities and arranged within shipping containers having dimensions as specified in table IV.

5.2.3 *Level C.*—Laces, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or Regulations of other carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.*—In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, intermediate packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Federal Standard No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.*—In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with ~~the requirements of~~ Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.—The nylon laces covered by this specification are intended for use on various types of footwear.

6.2 Ordering data.—Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify:

(*a*) Title, number and date of this specification.

(*b*) Class and length required (see 1.2.1 and 3.7).

(*c*) Color required (see 3.4).

(*d*) Whether identification of nylon is required (see 4.3.1.2).

(*e*) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

(*f*) Only one type, style, and size shipping container should be used for any one item for a specific level of shipment (see 5.2.1 and 5.2.2).

6.3 Sample.—For access to guide and shade samples, address the procuring office issuing the invitation for bids.

6.4 Transportation description.—Transportation description and minimum weight applicable to this commodity is:

Rail:

Laces, Shoe:

Carload minimum weight 20,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.

Motor:

Laces, Shoe:

Motor volume minimum weight 20,000 pounds.

Notice. — When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Army—Q
Navy—S MC
Air Force.

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